Alexander Dao

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Education

University of California, Santa Cruz — **Santa Cruz, CA**
Linguistics Major, Computer Science Minor — **Winter 2027**

Thesis:
The Visual Word Form Area, Autism, and Childhood Hyperlexia

Relevant Coursework:
CSE 13S (C Programming)
CSE 40 (Machine Learning in Python)
CSE 101 (Introduction to Data Structures and Algorithms)
CSE 150 (Introduction to Computer Networks)
CSE 151 (Advanced Computer Networks)

Experience

treemarks.ai — **Stanford**
Intern Software Engineer — **Jul 2026 - Present**

- Currently developing a streamlined, configurable AI shell for TA workflows by adapting an existing Claude-based grading agent and implementing core features for practical deployment.

The American Prospect — **Santa Cruz**
Intern Contributor, Tech Beat — **Dec 2025 - May 2026**

- Responsibilities included research, fact-checking, social media, data entry, and library services.
- Primary role expectations were editorial contributions, writing briefs and articles as assigned, generating story ideas, and pursuing individual projects with minimal staff guidance.
- Daily responsibilities included technical research, fact-checking, and data entry related to emerging AI technologies.

Paystand — **Santa Cruz**
Content Analytics Intern — **Jun 2024 – Jan 2025**

- Developed essential data entry and analytics skills, worked cross-departmentally with marketing and the CEO's office.
- Shadowed engineering, product, network infrastructure, and sales personnel in their day-to-day work.
- Tracked social metrics and analyzed platform growth for C-suite to improve community engagement with the company using Google Sheets/Excel.

Additional Experience

Independent Contractor **Santa Cruz**
Low Voltage Technician Apprentice **Jun 2023 – Aug 2023**

- Assisted with residential and commercial low-voltage cabling installation.
- Pulled, routed, and terminated structured cabling under supervision.
- Supported installation of networking, AV, and security wiring systems.

Student Broadcaster **Santa Cruz**
New Media Lit **Aug 2020 – Jun 2021**

- Primarily worked on the Editorial beat and supervised under a senior student editor.
- Leveraged Adobe Creative Suite and Google Suite to create short and long-form pieces, including a 2021 Capitol Hill piece and a collaborative behind-the-scenes audit of the school district's IT department.

Leadership & Activities

Society of Hispanic Professional Engineers **Santa Cruz**
Member **Nov 2025 - Present**

- Society of engineers from all Hispanic backgrounds, affiliated with clubs such as the National Society of Black Engineers (NSBE) and MESA.

- There is no requirement to be of Hispanic background; was invited by several friends including club officers and the president.

Math, Engineering & Science Achievement Program (MESA) **Santa Cruz**
Member **Feb 2025 -Present**

- Joint peer and staff-led mathematics, engineering, and sciences club @ UC Santa Cruz. Supports achievement for under-represented first-generation college students.

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Skills & Interests

Technical: C, Python, HTML, CSS
Language: English, Vietnamese, Japanese
Laboratory: Psycholinguistics, Neurolinguistics, Advanced Computer Networking
Interests: Sketching, Cycling, Water sports